



1

 SESSION —

Prompting as Spec-Writing, and Attribution

READY-MADE MATERIALS —

Use these when nobody has their own. Everything here is public or was written for this course.

The policy

Screen-share the current RAND AI-use policy and read the relevant passages aloud.

Bad prompt for the cold open

Summarize this report. Run it on the GAO High-Risk Series update (free at gao.gov/high-risk-list; also the document for Session 2).

The rewrite

I'm a RAND policy analyst drafting a two-page brief for congressional appropriations staff. Attached is GAO's latest High-Risk Series update. Summarize what changed since the previous update: areas added, removed, or with a changed rating. Under 250 words. Only claims GAO itself makes; no recommendations of your own. Output: a three-column table (area, what changed, page cite), then one paragraph on the overall trend.

Three bad prompts for anyone with no history to excavate

Is this methodology sound? with nothing attached. Write a lit review on sanctions effectiveness. Make this better, followed by any paragraph.